try to return in one way or another to the family of enlightened nations? Or was Saddam Hussein planning another “wild card” for us and the world, which, at the time of this assessment, could not be predicted?

- Whether Egypt would play a positive or negative role in the context of the peace process was not clear. At the time of this evaluation, Egypt had put quite a few spokes in the wheels of the process, and it was difficult to know what else awaited us with regard to this matter. Therefore this was an important issue to continue monitoring.
- We could expect that terrorist organizations would use nonconventional weapons. This assessment was validated in 1995 when a Japanese terrorist organization crossed the line regarding the use of chemical weapons for the first time in modern history. The “Engineer,” Yahya Ayyash, who had studied chemistry, chose to apply his knowledge to the development of conventional explosive devices for suicide bombers. One could not rule out the possibility that somewhere along the way, another chemistry student would choose the path of chemical terror.
- The final threat was that in future military confrontations there was a risk of attacks on Israeli population centers using surface- to-surface missiles with chemical warheads.
- Alongside the chances of peace within the range of the assessment—by the year 2000—we emphasized that true peace could be realized only if it was based on three essential factors: true reconciliation, economic and social prosperity, and democratization in the Arab world. I said then, in January 1991, that if I had to assess where we would be at the end of the twentieth century in terms of each of these three conditions, all I was willing to predict was that I was not sure we would achieve true reconciliation but that there was a chance of achieving coexistence with some degree of compromise. I was not sure that our neighbors would gain prosperity, but there was a good chance of achieving economic growth in the region. I was sure, I said, that we would not achieve democratization, but it was possible that by the end of the century the beginnings of political liberalism in the Middle East would be glimpsed.

It is important to draw attention to the geostrategic rift that had begun to develop around the time of this assessment in January 1991. From 1992, the